before returning to Malaysia and winning a landslide election to parliament in 2008.

The speech I gave at the Hack in the Box Conference focused on the history of unauthorised disclosure in the media. This, as I say, seems to me to be the backbone of journalism. It always surprises me when critics remark that WikiLeaks doesn't serve the interests of journalism because, whatever you might say about us, much of our work is, in some very obvious way, quite traditionalist. We aim to bring things into the light which certain powers would rather remain in the dark. That could have stood as a rubric of the *Times* of London during the Crimea. It was the silent motto of the *Washington Post* during Watergate. Coupled with this, I had always argued that WikiLeaks should be an organisation that partnered the established media, not one that either replaced it or shunned it. At the Malaysian conference, I made the point that, in the future, there might be a 'WikiLeaks button' that could be placed on the websites of major news organisations, to be used by people who had information. We would take on the burden of protecting the source and dealing with legal issues – our specialities, if you like – while the news organisation went about preparing stories and commentary around the leak. This was always our central idea, and though our organisation would be distracted by much hysteria over the coming two years, we return to this, notwithstanding that other organisations based on our work would claim the idea is new. OpenLeaks.org now uses this idea as a way of slamming the set-up of WikiLeaks, an unfortunate playground game that does no good to anybody. But let us be clear, I laid out the idea for co-operation with the media in Malaysia in 2009.

It was interesting to see how these subcultures work in modern life. Where the hacking scene in Europe or Australia is made up of middle-class or working-class kids, in Asia, typically, the people involved in this kind of work were part of some societal elite. But Malaysia's reforming groups are interested in advancement, wishing to increase the country's linguistic and ethnic diversity and break down the rigid racialisation of Malaysian politics. Just before we arrived, something new seemed to be happening: support for the old regime was waning. In the election of 2008 they gained less than the two-thirds majority required by law to amend the constitution, the first time this had happened since 1969. A number of by-elections throughout 2009 would, it was understood, act as a weather vane for the future of the